**Muhammad Talha Atif**
Full Stack Engineer
talhaatif573@gmail.com ◇ +923064391520 ◇ talha-atif.vercel.app ◇ LinkedIn

Hiring Team
Substack

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Full Stack Engineer role at Substack.

Substack is solving the right problem. Most platforms are built around maximising time spent, not around helping creators build something sustainable. The fact that Substack's entire product philosophy is about getting out of the way so a writer can focus on writing is not a small thing. It requires real product discipline to keep removing friction instead of adding features that look good on a roadmap but burden the user. That is the kind of engineering I want to be doing.

On the technical side, I have spent the past two years building and shipping production systems end to end across React and Next.js frontends, Node.js and Java Spring Boot backends, and PostgreSQL databases. At MicroTechX I took full ownership of a self-service IAM portal, redesigning the core user flow, fixing production crashes, and building analytics features without a product manager telling me what to prioritise. At Digital Upgraders I shipped features for a social platform for creative professionals, which included diagnosing and fixing a 2-second comment latency issue and reducing feed load time from 3 seconds to 700ms. Both of those were problems I found and fixed without being assigned to them.

Before those roles I delivered 10+ Android applications independently for freelance clients, managing everything from requirements through Play Store submission. Two of those apps are live with real users. That pattern of working without handholding is how I naturally operate and it is what Substack's job description is describing.

What I care most about is building things that feel right to use. I hold myself to a high standard on code quality, but I also care whether the interaction is actually pleasant. Those two things are not separate concerns.

I have attached my resume. My portfolio is at talha-atif.vercel.app if you would like to see the projects in detail.

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,

**Muhammad Talha Atif**